

Blair, Robinson, Fallon Pace 50-Year Voting

By AL MALLETT
Tabulations of the first 200 returns for Elmira's 50th Eastern League Anniversary baseball team show two recent favorites and three oldtimers running away from the field. Paul Blair, outfielder for the 1963 Pioneer and Eastern League bat champ, leads all players in the voting with 87 ballots for an outfield post. Dave McNally, a 15-game

winner in 1962, tops all the pitchers with 60 votes. He's a southpaw.

Two of the three oldtimers running away from the field are 1937-38 teammates George Fallon (second base) and Packy Rogers (third base) who have 69 and 66 votes for their positions.

The third is 1941 power-hitting first baseman Eddie

Robinson with 72 votes.

The balloting for the 50th Anniversary team will continue through June. Ballots are available at Dunn Field, Pioneer, Lag's, Horigan's, Rudy Baer's and Lagonegro's Cigar Store.

The players named to the 50th anniversary team will be honored at Elmira's anniversary party Monday, Aug. 14 at Dunn Field.

There a real surprise in the voting for the southpaw pitcher. Plus the fact that only a 15-game winner (McNally) is leading the way, the runnerup is Johnny Huisdos, a four-year favorite here from 1937-40 who was a winner every season but who never won more than 14 in a single year. Huisdos has 36 votes. Such big winners as Sad Sam Zoldak, Clarence (Lefty) Heise, Darold Knowles, Jimmy (Little Caesar) Lyons and Ted Pritchard aren't in the race as yet.

Robinson hold a big lead at first over popular Gerry Hannahoe, the big hitter of the 1935-36 Pioneers. Gerry has 27 votes.

Rogers is well on his way to victory. Only Blaine (Doc) Kunes (1933-34) seems a threat—and then only a mild one. Doc has 30 votes. Stellar third sacker, Clyde Parris (1954), Bob Wilson (1951) and Frank Madura (1941) are back in the field.

Fallon closest competitor at second is Walter (Rabbit) Maranville, the playing manager of the 1936 second-half pennant winners. Andy Cohen, Stan Sperry and Jimmy Bucker seem out of it.

Joining Blair as the leaders in the outfield are Jack Grossman, former football All-American at Rutgers who batted over .300 each of his four seasons as a Pioneer outfielder (1935-36-37-38). Grossman has 51 votes.

Then follow Pete Reiser, voted the player of the quarter century when that team was selected in the late Forties, with 48 votes; Johnny Mize 36, Johnny Rizzo 27, Curt Motton 24 and Rusty Saunders and Terry Moore 21 each. A surprise here is that George Staller an outfielder on the Silver Anniversary team and the 1939 Eastern League bat champ, is not listed among the top eight.

Great battles are shaping up for the shortstop, catcher and right handed pitcher.

Mark Belanger, the good glove, no hit shortstop of the 1962-68 Baltimore era here, is a surprise leader with 42 votes. But close behind is Don Zimmer (1951) with 39 and Ray White (1937) with 30. Both Zimmer and White were all-league shortstops and both hit better than 50 points higher than Belanger.

Elmer Klumpp, Les Moss, Fred Kendall and Johnny Pasek are the top four among the catchers with the powerful Klumpp leading the way with 39 votes. Klumpp was the big hitter for Maranville's 36 champs. Moss (1943) has 27, Kendall (1935) 15. Otto (Dutch) Denning, catcher on the Silver Anniversary team, is fifth with nine votes.



RED STAR — Cubap Communist leader Fidel Castro displays his basketball skills during workout at Sofia, Bulgaria, where the Cuban leader is visiting. Castro, as a youth, was a pretty good cager. (AP Wirephoto).

Baseball

Minnesota Twins slugger Tony Oliva will be activated Thursday when rookie outfielder Steve Brye leaves for two weeks of military duty, according to Twins Manager Bill Rigney.

Oliva, 1971 American League batting champion, has been on the disabled list all season. He underwent surgery on his right knee last September and has not fully recovered. "If I play I hit all right," said Oliva. "But who will catch the ball for me in the outfield?"

The Kansas City Royals said Tuesday they will not play baseball in the new Harry Truman sports complex this year. Ewing Kauffman, owner of the Royals said construction